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Analyzing Core Web Vitals: A Publishers Checklist to Enhancing UX & Revenue

Core Web Vitals (CWVs) have become a cornerstone of web performance, directly impacting user experience and SEO. For publishers, optimizing these metrics is crucial to ensuring that their websites not only perform well but also deliver a seamless experience across all devices. Here's a deep dive into how CWVs affect your site and how you can monitor and improve them effectively.



Content Highlights:

- What are the Core Web Vitals (CWVs)?
- How to Measure the Core Web Vitals (CWVs)
- The Importance of Monitoring Core Web Vitals (CWVs)
- How to Monitor and Improve Core Web Vitals (CWVs)
- Final Thoughts

What is Core Web Vitals (CWVs)

Core Web Vitals are a set of specific metrics defined by Google that measure key aspects of user experience on a website. These metrics focus on three main areas: loading performance, interactivity, and visual stability. They are designed to ensure that websites provide a smooth, fast, and user-friendly experience across all devices. Here are the three Core Web Vitals (CWVs) and how they're measured.

How to Measure The Core Web Vitals (CWVs)

Below are the CWV metrics that show what they measure on the page:

• Largest Contentful Paint (LCP) – visual load

This metric measures when the user begins loading the page until the most significant element—an image, ad, or text block—is rendered within the viewport. A low LCP score indicates that the main content is visible quickly, while a high LCP score suggests that it takes longer for the main content to be visible. This can lead to poor user experience, as users may become frustrated while waiting for the main content to load.

• Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS) – visual stability

CLS measures the most significant burst of layout shift scores caused by unexpected changes in element positions throughout a page's lifespan. A layout shift occurs whenever a visible element changes its position between consecutive frames.

Websites should aim for a CLS score of 0.1 or lower to provide an optimal user experience. This score should be measured against the 75th percentile of page loads, segmented across mobile and desktop devices to ensure consistency.

- **FID (First Input Delay) – interactivity**

FID is a crucial, user-centric metric for measuring load responsiveness because it quantifies the experience users have when trying to interact with unresponsive pages.

A low FID helps ensure that the page is usable. Pages should have an FID of 100 milliseconds or fewer to provide a good user experience.

- **INP (Interaction to next Paint) - Interactivity Responsiveness**

INP is the successor metric to [First Input Delay \(FID\)](#). While both are responsiveness metrics, FID only measures the input delay of the first interaction on a page.

INP improves on FID by considering all page interactions, beginning with the input delay, moving on to the time it takes to run event handlers, and finally, until the browser has painted the next frame.

INP is considered a more reliable indicator of overall responsiveness, regardless of when interactions occur in the life of a page. Google defines [a good INP](#) as one that falls below 200ms. Read more on how to [optimize your INP here](#).

Core Web Vitals are influenced by various factors such as server response time, page layout, content, browser, device, and other parameters. To improve performance, websites should identify areas where these vitals fall outside the preferred performance range and address any issues. Here are some dimensions to focus on, as they directly impact page speed: **Page URL, Browser, Version, Device, Network Types, and Window Size.**

Competitive Advantage

Staying ahead in the competitive digital landscape means delivering an exceptional user experience. Leveraging CWVs helps position your website as a leader in performance and user satisfaction.

Watch the [AY Yield Intelligence Demo](#) to learn more about analyzing massive granular data in real-time across Prebid, Amazon, Direct Sales, and Programmatic, with over 200 unique metrics!



How to Monitor and Improve Core Web Vitals

Page speed is essential for user experience and search engine optimization, so ensuring your website loads quickly and efficiently is vital.

You should start setting up a dashboard that provides page speed insights, which is very useful for monitoring your website's performance while making changes to improve it.

Average CWV scores sorted by PageViews Descending

Content	WV Avg. LCP Avg. 1.02	WV Avg. FID Avg. 45.32	WV Avg. CLS Avg. 0.02	PageViews Sum: 203,747	WV Avg. INP Avg. 108.20
/forum/	1.01	38.22	0.01	24,814	143.82
/forum/unread-thread-list/	0.70	29.10	0.01	20,578	68.55
/	1.28	52.58	0.01	13,937	180.70
/forum/thread/16700-neue-ent09-2024/	0.65	84.14	0.02	6,128	61
/forum/aktuelle-themen/	0.78	70.15	0.01	5,358	291.62
/forum/thread/2350-bilder-vom-tage/	0.92	65.36	0.05	4,722	365.81
/unread-thread-list/	0.78	31.94	0.02	3,238	258.40
/forum/thread/6488-was-habt-ih-euch-neues-gekauft-%C3%BCber-10-euro/	1.19	55.79	0.03	2,774	102.10
/thread/147768-und-noch-ein-unangek%C3%BCndigtes-event-happy-earth-day/	0.93	67.98	0.05	2,309	132.18
/forum/thread/2080-humor/	0.80	39.80	0.05	2,138	154.29
/forum/thread/8579-der-was-habt-ih-zuletzt-an-eurem-motorad-gemacht-thread/	0.69	65.65	0.02	1,441	157.78
/forum/thread/13673-umstieg-von-ders-auf-die-stas/	0.70	80.47	0.03	1,412	892
/forum/thread/12099-android-auto-wireless/	0.56	28.63	0.03	1,383	82.13
/forum/thread/14378-lustige-bilder-memes-comics-etc/	0.74	125.07	0.07	1,302	122.20
/thread/147837-update-vom-26-04-24/	0.99	73.20	0.02	1,151	264.95
/thread/103361-jungs-gegen-m%C3%A4dels/	0.79	43.54	0.03	1,139	144.36
/thread/147839-ereignis-kalenderwoche-18-2024/	0.99	68.91	0.02	1,090	188.52
/forum/thread/13997-motoradonline-de-und-denen-berichte-%C3%BCber-chinesische-motor%C3%A4der/	0.86	151.31	0.05	1,088	46.50
/forum/thread/437-inspektion/	0.82	129.88	0.06	1,084	32
/forum/thread/14040-kiamotten-style-beim-motorad-fahren/	0.78	53.23	0.05	1,075	120

1/100

*Source: Assertive Yield's Demo data - Web Analytics

1. Set Up Performance Dashboards

Implement dashboards to gain insights into CWV metrics and monitor performance. [Assertive Yield](#) offers several holistic dashboard templates to help you analyze and report on Core Web Vitals effectively:

- **Average CWV Score by Pageview:** Tracks the average CWV scores across different page views, helping you gauge overall site performance.
- **CWV Performance by Domain & Device:** Provides insights into CWV metrics segmented by domain and device, enabling targeted improvements.
- **LCP Performance:** Focuses on the Largest Contentful Paint scores, identifying pages and elements causing delays.
- **INP Performance:** Monitors the Interaction to Next Paint metric, helping you improve responsiveness across all interactions.
- **CLS Performance:** Evaluates the Cumulative Layout Shift, identifying areas where content shifts unexpectedly.
- And more

These dashboards provide detailed views of your site's performance and help identify areas for improvement.

Name: Web Vital LCP Alert ID: Alert ID

Description: This is to send an alert when any inventory goes above the average LCP score of 3.5

Target Type: Entities Targets to Check: WSC

Type: Yield Metric: WV Avg. LCP Dimensions: Browser Domain

Trigger: Operator: Above by: 3.5 Level: Info Remove: X

Add trigger

Filter: Condition Match Type Value

Add Filter

Notification Groups: Editorial

Add Alert Reset Form

**Source: Assertive Yield's Demo Data - Alerts*

2. Utilize Real-Time Alerts

[Assertive Yield](#)'s real-time alert templates can notify you when CWV metrics exceed optimal thresholds. This proactive approach ensures that you can address performance issues promptly:

- **Web Vitals LCP Alert:** For example, this alert sends a notification when LCP scores surpass the average threshold of 3.5 seconds(set to your custom preference), allowing for quick action.
- **Web Vitals CLS Alert:** Notifies you when CLS scores exceed the average threshold of 0.2, helping maintain visual stability.
- **Web Vitals INP Alert:** Alerts you when INP scores go beyond the average threshold of 200 milliseconds, ensuring ongoing responsiveness.

3. Analyze and Optimize

Regularly test and measure your site's performance using tools like A/B/n testing to refine your optimizations. Focus on key dimensions such as Page URL, Browser, Device, Network Types, and Window Size to ensure comprehensive performance improvements.

4. AI Layouts for Enhanced Performance

Assertive Yield's AI Layouts can significantly improve Core Web Vitals metrics, especially [INP](#) and LCP. These layouts optimize loading speed and responsiveness, leading to a better user experience and higher engagement. Explore AI Layouts. Read our [latest product update](#) to learn more about new metrics available in AY.

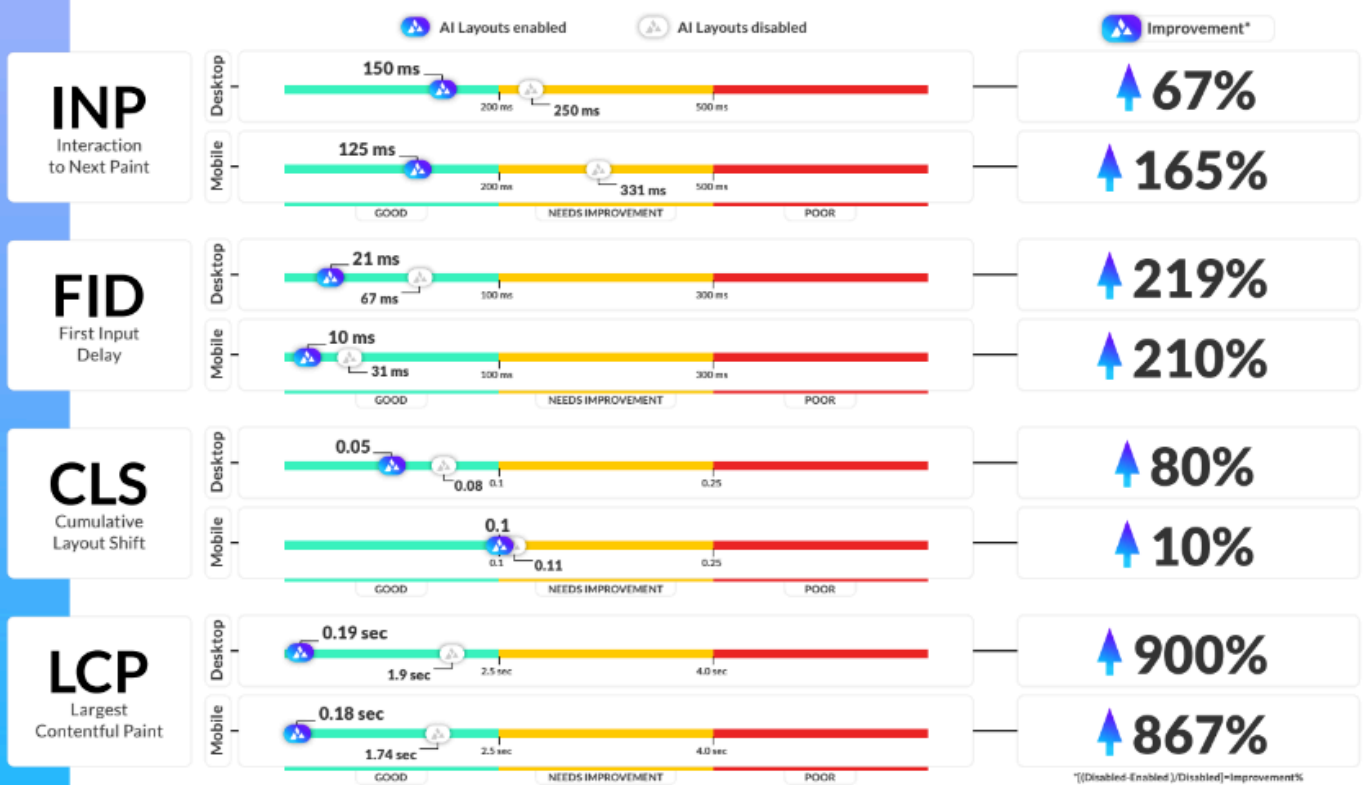
Other aspects to consider include:

5. Analyze Your Current Performance
6. Identify Bottlenecks
7. Optimize Page Load Speed
8. Prioritize Interactivity
9. Tackle Visual Stability
10. Continuously Monitor and Iterate
11. Test and Measure Using [A/B/n testing](#)

Let's buckle up as we take you on a practical journey toward boosting your web performance score. Armed with powerful dashboards and real-time alerts, you'll be unstoppable.

In the image below, we're examining the Core Web Vitals among Assertive Yield's partners, comparing Desktop and Mobile.

Core Web Vitals Performance Among AY's Partners



*Source: Assertive Yield's Demo data - Web Analytics

Final Thoughts

Optimizing Core Web Vitals is essential for publishers looking to enhance user experience, improve SEO, and boost revenue. By leveraging the right tools and strategies, such as Assertive Yield's dashboards and real-time alerts, you can maintain high-performance standards and stay ahead of the competition.

For more in-depth strategies for improving your site's performance, download your complete guide, [Boosting Performance Metrics for Digital Publishers](#), which delves into advanced techniques for optimizing key metrics.

free report

Download now

COMPLETE GUIDE

Boosting Performance Metrics for Digital Publishers

Next steps: Read our next article, on [Leveraging Advanced Prebid Analytics to Boost Programmatic Revenue](#), to further optimize your monetization strategy.

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